

Verb Stories — Read & Listen

Grade 7 Irregular Verbs · All-English Edition

17 short stories

Original stories. Verb forms checked against a verified list. Word meanings are written in simple English for young learners.

Story 1

The Big Race

Narrative

Last Saturday **was** our school's sports day. I **woke** up early because I **felt** nervous. I **was** in the eight-hundred-meter race. My mom **made** a big breakfast, but I only **drank** some milk. At school, I **met** my best friend, Kevin. He **brought** me a lucky bracelet and **said**, "You will win!" I **thought** he was just being kind. When the race **began**, I **ran** as fast as I could. Halfway through, I **fell** down and **hurt** my knee. Everyone **saw** it, and I wanted to give up. But then I **heard** my class shouting my name. So I **stood** up and **ran** again. I did not **come** first. I **came** fourth. But when I crossed the line, my whole class **ran** to me. They **caught** me, and Kevin **gave** me a big smile. That day, I **lost** the race, but I **found** something better. I finally **understood** what real friends are.

Verbs in this story

Base	Past	Past Participle	Meaning
be	was / were	been	to exist, or to happen
wake	woke	woken	to stop sleeping and open your eyes
feel	felt	felt	to notice something happening in your body or mind
make	made	made	to create or produce something new
drink	drank	drunk	to take liquid into your mouth and swallow it
meet	met	met	to come together with someone in the same place
bring	brought	brought	to carry something to a place
say	said	said	to speak words out loud
think	thought	thought	to use your mind to form ideas or opinions
begin	began	begun	to start doing or happening
run	ran	run	to move very fast using your legs
fall	fell	fallen	to drop down to a lower place
hurt	hurt	hurt	to cause pain to someone
see	saw	seen	to notice something with your eyes

hear	heard	heard	to notice sounds with your ears
stand	stood	stood	to be on your feet, not sitting
come	came	come	to move toward a place or person
catch	caught	caught	to take hold of something that is moving
give	gave	given	to hand something to someone
lose	lost	lost	to not have something you had before
find	found	found	to see or get something after looking for it
understand	understood	understood	to know what something means

Think about it

Q: Why did the boy only drink some milk in the morning?

A: Because he felt nervous.

Q: What did the boy do after he fell down?

A: He stood up and ran again.

Q: He lost the race, but what did he find?

A: He found what real friends are.

Story 2

The Day the Storm Hit Our Town

Narrative

Last August, a big storm **hit** our small town. The radio station **broadcast** a warning early in the morning, but we were already outside playing. Dark clouds **spread** across the sky in just a few minutes. The rain **wet** my whole body before I even reached the front door. I rushed inside, and Mom **shut** all the windows quickly. She **put** some old towels along the bottom of the door. Suddenly, a tree branch **burst** through our neighbor's car window with a loud crack. My little sister **cut** her finger on a piece of broken glass. It **hurt** badly, and she started to cry. Dad quickly **set** the first aid kit on the table. Mom **read** the instructions on the box out loud. The storm **cost** our family a lot of money to fix the house. It also **upset** many other families in our neighborhood. My sister **quit** trying to clean up and just sat down on the couch. Dad **let** us all sleep in the living room that night. By the next morning, the damage had **spread** to almost every street in town.

Verbs in this story

Base	Past	Past Participle	Meaning
broadcast	broadcast	broadcast	to send a program out on radio or TV
burst	burst	burst	to suddenly break open with force
cost	cost	cost	to need a certain amount of money
cut	cut	cut	to use a sharp tool to divide something
hit	hit	hit	to touch something quickly and with force
hurt	hurt	hurt	to cause pain to someone
let	let	let	to allow someone to do something
put	put	put	to move something to a place or position
quit	quit	quit	to stop doing something or leave a job
read	read	read	to look at words and understand them
set	set	set	to put something in a certain place or position
shut	shut	shut	to close something completely

spread	spread	spread	to open out or move to a wider area
upset	upset	upset	to make someone feel sad or worried
wet	wet	wet	to make something covered with water

Think about it

Q: What did the radio station do early in the morning?

A: The radio station **broadcast** a warning early in the morning.

Q: How did the sister get hurt?

A: She **cut** her finger on a piece of broken glass, and it **hurt** badly.

Q: What did Dad do for the family that night?

A: Dad **let** them all sleep in the living room.

Story 3

Benny's Big Run

Joke

Last year, a new PE teacher named Mr. Lin **came** to our school. He **became** famous very quickly — everyone loved his fun classes. Every morning, he **ran** five laps around the track before the bell rang. One Monday, a lazy student named Benny **came** to school early by accident. He saw Mr. Lin running and shouted, "I want to become as fast as you!" Mr. Lin smiled and said, "Then come back at seven tomorrow!" The next morning, Benny **came** back at exactly seven o'clock. He **ran** with all his strength toward the finish line. But after just ten meters, he tripped over a cone and **became** a human bowling ball. He **ran** into five cones and knocked them all down in a perfect line. Mr. Lin clapped slowly and said, "Benny, that was the most impressive ten meters I have ever seen."

Verbs in this story

Base	Past	Past Participle	Meaning
become	became	become	to start to be something different
come	came	come	to move toward a place or person
run	ran	run	to move very fast using your legs

Think about it

Q: Why did Mr. Lin come to school early every day?

A: He **came** to school early and **ran** five laps around the track.

Q: What happened to Benny after he started running?

A: Benny **ran** into five cones and **became** a human bowling ball.

Q: How did Benny become famous at the end of the story?

A: Benny **became** famous for running the most impressive ten meters ever seen.

Story 4

Two Gifts, One Teacher

Dialogue

"I **thought** we were buying Ms. Chen's birthday gift together," said Mia. Jay looked down and said, "I'm sorry. I already **bought** her a book this morning." "A book?" said Mia. "I **thought** you were going to wait for me!" "I know," said Jay. "I **brought** it to school in my backpack." "Well, I **bought** a card," Mia said. "Now she'll get two things separately." "Let's not fight about it," said Jay. "We **fought** about the science project last week, too!" said Mia. "I **thought** about that," Jay said quietly. "I was wrong that time." "Ms. Chen **taught** us to always communicate better," said Mia. "She **taught** us a lot," Jay admitted. "I should have told you earlier." Mia **caught** a glimpse of Jay's book sticking out of his bag. "Oh no," she said. "I almost **bought** the same one!" Jay laughed. "I **sought** the perfect gift in three different stores," he said. "And I **caught** the last card at the bookstore just in time," said Mia, smiling now. "So together," said Jay, "we **brought** her the perfect combination." "I **thought** you'd find a way to make this okay," said Mia.

Verbs in this story

Base	Past	Past Participle	Meaning
bring	brought	brought	to carry something to a place
buy	bought	bought	to get something by paying money
catch	caught	caught	to take hold of something that is moving
fight	fought	fought	to use force or words against someone
seek	sought	sought	to look carefully for something
teach	taught	taught	to help someone learn new things
think	thought	thought	to use your mind to form ideas or opinions

Think about it

Q: What did Jay bring to school for Ms. Chen?

A: Jay **brought** a book to school in his backpack.

Q: What did Ms. Chen teach her students?

A: She **taught** them to always communicate better.

Q: How did Jay find the perfect gift for Ms. Chen?

A: Jay **sought** the perfect gift in three different stores.

Story 5

The Night Leo Could Not Sleep

Narrative

One cold night, Grandma **swept** the floor before bed. She **kept** the lights low and the house quiet. Little Leo watched her from the doorway. "Why do you always sweep at night?" he asked. "A clean home **kept** the bad dreams away," Grandma said softly. Leo nodded and went to his room. He lay down and soon **slept** without any worries. But in the middle of the night, Leo heard a soft sound. He walked to the living room and found Grandma sitting alone. Tears ran down her face — she **wept** quietly by the window. "Grandma, what's wrong?" Leo asked softly. She **kept** her voice steady and said, "I miss Grandpa." Leo sat beside her and held her hand tight. They talked until the sadness **swept** away like a soft wind. That night, Leo **slept** with a warm feeling in his heart.

Verbs in this story

Base	Past	Past Participle	Meaning
keep	kept	kept	to continue to have or do something
sleep	slept	slept	to close your eyes and rest your body
sweep	swept	swept	to clean a floor using a brush
weep	wept	wept	to cry with many tears from your eyes

Think about it

Q: What did Grandma do every night before bed?

A: She **swept** the floor before bed.

Q: What was Grandma doing when Leo found her by the window?

A: She **wept** quietly by the window.

Q: How did Leo feel when he finally went back to sleep?

A: He **slept** with a warm feeling in his heart.

Story 6

A Box Full of Friendship

Dialogue

"Tom **left** for Canada last week," Maya said to Ben. "I know. I **felt** so sad when he went," Ben replied. "I **spent** two whole days not knowing what to do," said Maya. "What do you mean?" asked Ben. "I **meant** we should do something special for him," Maya answered. "You **built** that little wooden box, right? Can we use it?" she asked. "Sure! And I already **lent** you my blue paint. Remember?" Ben said. Maya **bent** down to pick up a pen from her bag. "What should I write?" she asked. "I **dealt** with the photos. You write the letter," Ben said. Maya nodded and wrote for a long time. "I **meant** every word," she said when she finished. "Perfect. Let's put everything in the box," Ben said. The next morning, they **sent** the package to Tom's new address. "I hope he smiles when he opens it," Maya said with a warm smile.

Verbs in this story

Base	Past	Past Participle	Meaning
bend	bent	bent	to make something curve, not stay straight
build	built	built	to make a structure by putting parts together
deal	dealt	dealt	to handle a problem or difficult situation
feel	felt	felt	to notice something happening in your body or mind
leave	left	left	to go away from a place
lend	lent	lent	to let someone use something for a while
mean	meant	meant	to stand for or express an idea
send	sent	sent	to make something go to another place
spend	spent	spent	to use money or time on something

Think about it

Q: Why did Maya and Ben want to make a gift?

A: Because Tom **left** for Canada last week.

Q: What did Ben make that they could use for the gift?

A: He **built** a small wooden box.

Q: When did they send the package to Tom?

A: They **sent** it the next morning.

Story 7

The Night of the Big Storm

Narrative

Last summer, our class **met** at the foot of a big mountain for a camping trip. Our teacher, Mr. Lin, **led** us along a narrow forest trail. We **found** a perfect campsite near a cool stream. Sam **dug** a small hole to build the campfire. Mr. Lin **lit** the fire, and everyone cheered. We **fed** the fire with dry wood to keep warm. Then a storm **struck** without warning. A rope on a tree **swung** wildly in the strong wind. We **lost** our map in the dark. A wet rock **slid** down the slope and knocked over our tent. Mr. Lin **held** his flashlight high and told us to stay calm. He **hung** a bright orange flag from a tall branch so we could be seen. We all **sat** close together under a big rock for shelter. Suddenly, I **heard** a helicopter in the distance. Mr. Lin **shot** a signal flare into the dark sky. The rescue team **found** us and took us home safely. Later, our class **won** an award for staying calm in the storm.

Verbs in this story

Base	Past	Past Participle	Meaning
dig	dug	dug	to make a hole in the ground
feed	fed	fed	to give food to a person or animal
find	found	found	to see or get something after looking for it
hang	hung	hung	to fix something on a hook above the ground
hear	heard	heard	to notice sounds with your ears
hold	held	held	to keep something firmly in your hands
lead	led	led	to go first and show others the way
light	lit	lit	to make something start burning or shining
lose	lost	lost	to not have something you had before
meet	met	met	to come together with someone in the same place
shoot	shot	shot	to fire a gun or weapon at something
sit	sat	sat	to rest with your body on a seat
slide	slid	slid	to move smoothly along a surface

strike	struck	struck	to hit something hard with force
swing	swung	swung	to move back and forth smoothly in the air
win	won	won	to be the best in a game or competition

Think about it

Q: How did Mr. Lin call for help during the storm?

A: He **shot** a signal flare into the dark sky.

Q: Where did the students go to stay safe from the storm?

A: They **sat** close together under a big rock.

Q: What did the class win after the camping trip?

A: They **won** an award for staying calm in the storm.

Story 8

The Bakery

Dialogue

Lily **stood** outside a small bakery and looked inside. "Good morning!" Mr. Chen **said**. "Come in!" "Good morning," Lily **said**. "My mom **told** me about your bread." "She **had** a slice last week and loved it," Lily **said**. Mr. Chen smiled. "I **made** a new batch this morning," he **said**. "I **laid** them on the counter at six o'clock," he **told** her. "I **sold** half of them before eight," he **said**. Lily **understood** why people came here every day. "How much for one?" she asked. "One dollar each," Mr. Chen **said**. Lily **had** only two dollars, but she smiled. She **paid** for two rolls and **said**, "Thank you so much!" "Come back tomorrow!" Mr. Chen **said** with a big smile.

Verbs in this story

Base	Past	Past Participle	Meaning
have	had	had	to own something or hold it as yours
lay	laid	laid	to put something flat on a surface
make	made	made	to create or produce something new
pay	paid	paid	to give money for something
say	said	said	to speak words out loud
sell	sold	sold	to give something to someone for money
stand	stood	stood	to be on your feet, not sitting
tell	told	told	to give someone information using words
understand	understood	understood	to know what something means

Think about it

Q: What did Lily's mom tell her before she went to the bakery?

A: She told Lily about the bakery.

Q: How much of the bread did Mr. Chen sell before eight o'clock?

A: He sold half of the bread rolls before eight.

Q: How much did Lily pay for the rolls?

A: She paid two dollars for two rolls.

Story 9

The Summer Swim Camp

Narrative

Last summer, my class went to a swim camp for a week. Every day **began** with an early swim in the pool. The coach **rang** the bell at seven sharp. We jumped in and **swam** three laps together. My friend Leo **drank** some pool water by mistake. He laughed, and his goggles **sank** to the bottom. That evening, we had a talent show. The show had already **begun** when I found my seat. My classmate Mia **sang** two beautiful songs on stage. When she had **sung** the last note, everyone cheered. After the show, we sat outside and **drank** hot chocolate. Someone **began** to sing a camp song around the fire. Soon, we all **sang** along and laughed under the stars. I had never **swum** so much before, but I loved every moment.

Verbs in this story

Base	Past	Past Participle	Meaning
begin	began	begun	to start doing or happening
drink	drank	drunk	to take liquid into your mouth and swallow it
ring	rang	rung	to make a clear sound like a bell
sing	sang	sung	to make music with your voice
sink	sank	sunk	to go down below the surface of water
swim	swam	swum	to move through water using your arms and legs

Think about it

Q: How did every day start at the swim camp?

A: Every day began with an early swim in the pool.

Q: What happened to Leo's goggles in the pool?

A: His goggles sank to the bottom.

Q: What did Mia do at the talent show?

A: She sang two beautiful songs on stage.

Story 10

A Perfect Day for Kites

Narrative

Last spring, my family went to a big park on a windy day. My dad **knew** the perfect spot to fly kites there. He **grew** up flying kites in that very park. The wind **blew** hard and the sky was bright blue. My sister **drew** the kite design herself — a red dragon. Dad **threw** the kite into the air and let go of the string. The kite **flew** up, up, and up into the blue sky. Birds **flew** past the kite and seemed surprised. I **knew** it would be a great day. Mom **drew** a picture of us holding the kite string. Then a strong gust **blew** the kite even higher. The kite had **flown** farther than we expected. My little brother **threw** a paper airplane into the wind too. The trees had **grown** tall around us, and the park looked beautiful. The wind **blew** softly at last, and we sat down to rest.

Verbs in this story

Base	Past	Past Participle	Meaning
blow	blew	blown	to push air out of your mouth
draw	drew	drawn	to make a picture using a pen or pencil
fly	flew	flown	to move through the air
grow	grew	grown	to get bigger over time
know	knew	known	to have information in your mind
throw	threw	thrown	to send something through the air with your hand

Think about it

Q: What did Dad do with the kite at the park?

A: He threw the kite into the air.

Q: Who drew the kite design?

A: My sister drew the kite design — a red dragon.

Q: How was the weather when they arrived at the park?

A: The wind blew hard and the sky was bright blue.

Story 11

The Missing Scarf

Narrative

Last winter, Mia **woke** up with a great idea. She **chose** the softest blue wool at the market. She **wove** it carefully into a warm scarf. She **spoke** to her friend Leo about it. She wanted to give the scarf to her grandmother as a gift. But when she **got** home, she found her bag on the floor. Someone had **stolen** the scarf! Mia **got** very upset. She **froze** at the door, unable to move. She had **forgotten** to zip her bag that morning. Her heart **broke** when she thought about Grandma. She ran to tell her teacher. The teacher helped find the scarf. It was not **broken** — just a little dirty.

Verbs in this story

Base	Past	Past Participle	Meaning
break	broke	broken	to make something fall into pieces
choose	chose	chosen	to pick the one you want from several
forget	forgot	forgotten	to not be able to remember something
freeze	froze	frozen	to turn into ice because of cold
get	got	gotten	to receive or come to have something
speak	spoke	spoken	to use your voice to say words
steal	stole	stolen	to take something that belongs to someone else
wake	woke	woken	to stop sleeping and open your eyes
weave	wove	woven	to make cloth by crossing thin strings together

Think about it

Q: What did Mia choose at the market?

A: She **chose** the softest blue wool. 她選了最柔軟的藍色羊毛。

Q: What happened to the scarf?

A: Someone had **stolen** it. 有人偷走了它。

Q: What did Mia forget to do that morning?

A: She had **forgotten** to zip her bag. 她忘記拉上袋子的拉鍊。

Story 12

The Worst Excuse

Joke

Max **wrote** a note to get out of gym class. He **hid** it inside his book. But his dog had **hidden** it somewhere else! Max **rode** his bike to school with no excuse note. He had **written** three drafts but lost them all. In gym class, a bee **bit** him on the nose. Now he had a real excuse — a bee had **bitten** him! But the teacher laughed. She had **ridden** a horse that morning and was in a great mood. "You should have **written** about your dog," she said with a smile.

Verbs in this story

Base	Past	Past Participle	Meaning
bite	bit	bitten	to use your teeth to cut into something
hide	hid	hidden	to go where others cannot see you
ride	rode	ridden	to sit on and control a horse or bike
write	wrote	written	to make letters or words on paper

Think about it

Q: What did Max write at the beginning of the story?

A: He **wrote** a note to get out of gym class. 他寫了一張便條，想逃掉體育課。

Q: What happened to Max during gym class?

A: A bee **bit** him on the nose. 一隻蜜蜂咬了他的鼻子。

Q: Why was the teacher in such a great mood?

A: She had **ridden** a horse that morning. 她那天早上騎了馬。

Story 13

The Ugly Shirt

Narrative

Amy **wore** the same ugly school shirt every day. She had **worn** it for three years. One day, she **tore** it on a nail by the door. The shirt was badly **torn** down the side. She **bore** the embarrassment all morning. At lunch, she **swore** she would change the school uniform rules. She had **sworn** this before, but never did anything. She **bore** the heavy feeling in her chest all afternoon. She **wore** her jacket to cover the tear. After school, she wrote a letter to the principal. She listed all the problems she had **borne** for years. The principal read the letter carefully. A week later, the school got new uniforms. Amy smiled when she **tore** up her old shirt.

Verbs in this story

Base	Past	Past Participle	Meaning
swear	swore	sworn	to make a serious promise to do something
tear	tore	torn	to pull something apart by force
wear	wore	worn	to have clothes on your body
bear	bore	borne	to accept something painful without giving up

Think about it

Q: What happened to Amy's shirt one day?

A: She **tore** it on a nail, and it was badly **torn**. 她把它勾在釘子上撕破了，撕得很嚴重。

Q: What did Amy swear to do at lunch?

A: She **swore** she would change the school uniform rules. 她發誓要改變校服規定。

Q: What did Amy list in her letter to the principal?

A: She listed all the problems she had **borne** for years. 她列出了多年來忍受的所有問題。

Story 14

After the Big Game

Dialogue

Sara **saw** Ben sitting alone after the big game. "I **was** so nervous during the last minute," Ben said. "You **did** great out there," Sara told him. "But their team **beat** us by five points," Ben said sadly. "We have never **been** this unlucky before," Sara agreed. "Our coach **gave** us a long talk after," Ben said. "He **showed** us our mistakes on video," Ben continued. "He also **took** away our phones during the meeting," Ben added. "I **ate** nothing after the game," Ben said quietly. "I **went** straight home and felt terrible," he added. "My mom **drove** me home in silence," Ben said. "The sun **rose** before I could fall asleep," he continued. Sara **shook** her head. "That's really tough." "I even **fell** asleep in class today," Ben admitted with a weak smile. "Have you **forgiven** yourself?" Sara asked gently. "Not yet, but this loss has **driven** me to practice harder," Ben said with a smile.

Verbs in this story

Base	Past	Past Participle	Meaning
be	was	been	to exist, or to happen
beat	beat	beaten	to hit someone or do better than them
do	did	done	to carry out an action or task
drive	drove	driven	to control a car and make it move
eat	ate	eaten	to put food in your mouth and swallow it
fall	fell	fallen	to drop down to a lower place
forgive	forgave	forgiven	to stop being angry at someone
give	gave	given	to hand something to someone
go	went	gone	to move from one place to another
rise	rose	risen	to move up to a higher level
see	saw	seen	to notice something with your eyes
shake	shook	shaken	to move something quickly from side to side
show	showed	shown	to let someone see something

take	took	taken	to pick up and carry something away
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Think about it

Q: How did Sara find Ben after the game?

A: She **saw** him sitting alone. 她看到他獨自坐著。

Q: What did the coach do during the team meeting?

A: He **showed** them their mistakes on video and **took** away their phones. 他給他們看了影片中的錯誤，並沒收了他們的手機。

Q: What did the loss do for Ben in the end?

A: It had **driven** him to practice harder. 它激勵他更努力練習了。

Story 15

The Secret of Storm Cave

Story

Last summer, Leo and his best friend Mia **found** an old map inside a dusty book at the village library. The map **showed** a hidden cave deep in the forest, marked with an X and the words "Storm Cave." "Someone **drew** this map over a hundred years ago," Leo **said**, his eyes wide with excitement. They **put** on their backpacks and **left** home before sunrise the next morning. The two friends walked through tall trees for two hours until they **came** to a steep rocky hill. At the base of the hill, they **saw** a narrow opening half-hidden by vines — the entrance to Storm Cave. Leo **took** a deep breath, **kept** his flashlight steady, and **led** the way inside. The air **grew** cold and damp as they moved deeper into the darkness. Suddenly, Mia **heard** a strange sound echoing off the cave walls. She **held** Leo's arm and **spoke** quietly: "Did you hear that?" Leo **shone** his flashlight ahead and they **saw** a huge colony of bats hanging from the ceiling. "Don't make a sound," Leo **told** her, and they moved carefully past the sleeping bats. After a few minutes, they **felt** the ground slope steeply downward. They **slid** down the slippery path and landed in a wide underground chamber. In the center of the room, half-buried in mud, **sat** an old wooden chest. Mia **ran** toward it and **dug** away the mud with her bare hands. She **found** a rusty lock, but **broke** a stick trying to pry it open. Leo **thought** for a moment, then **hit** the lock hard with a heavy rock. The lock **fell** off, and they opened the chest with shaking hands. Inside, they **saw** old gold coins, a jade necklace, and a handwritten letter. But just then, water **began** to pour through cracks in the cave wall. Leo **knew** they had to leave fast — the water was rising quickly. They **took** the letter and a handful of coins, **put** everything in the backpack, and **ran** back toward the exit. The cold water **rose** fast and soon reached their knees. Mia slipped on a wet rock and **fell** into the water, but Leo **caught** her hand just in time. They **fought** against the current and **kept** pushing forward, step by step. Finally, Leo **saw** a small

beam of light ahead — the exit! They **swam** through the last flooded section and **burst** out of the cave into the pouring rain. Outside, they **stood** on the hillside, soaking wet and out of breath, but safe. Leo **held** up the old letter and **read** the last line aloud. The letter **said**, "This cave gives its treasure only to the brave." Mia smiled and **said**, "I think we just **won** today."

Verbs in this story

Base	Past	Past Participle	Meaning
find	found	found	to see or get something after looking for it
show	showed	shown	to let someone see something
draw	drew	drawn	to make a picture using a pen or pencil
say	said	said	to speak words out loud
put	put	put	to move something to a place or position
leave	left	left	to go away from a place
come	came	come	to move toward a place or person
see	saw	seen	to notice something with your eyes
take	took	taken	to pick up and carry something away
keep	kept	kept	to continue to have or do something
lead	led	led	to go first and show others the way
grow	grew	grown	to get bigger over time
hear	heard	heard	to notice sounds with your ears
hold	held	held	to keep something firmly in your hands
speak	spoke	spoken	to use your voice to say words
shine	shone (照耀) / shined (擦亮)	shone (照耀) / shined (擦亮)	to give out bright light
tell	told	told	to give someone information using words
feel	felt	felt	to notice something happening in your body or mind
slide	slid	slid	to move smoothly along a surface
sit	sat	sat	to rest with your body on a seat

run	ran	run	to move very fast using your legs
dig	dug	dug	to make a hole in the ground
break	broke	broken	to make something fall into pieces
think	thought	thought	to use your mind to form ideas or opinions
hit	hit	hit	to touch something quickly and with force
fall	fell	fallen	to drop down to a lower place
begin	began	begun	to start doing or happening
know	knew	known	to have information in your mind
rise	rose	risen	to move up to a higher level
catch	caught	caught	to take hold of something that is moving
fight	fought	fought	to use force or words against someone
swim	swam	swum	to move through water using your arms and legs
burst	burst	burst	to suddenly break open with force
stand	stood	stood	to be on your feet, not sitting
read	read	read	to look at words and understand them
win	won	won	to be the best in a game or competition

Think about it

Q: What did Leo and Mia find in the village library?

A: They **found** an old map inside a dusty book.

Q: How did Leo and Mia escape from the flooded cave?

A: They **swam** through the flooded section and **burst** out of the cave.

Q: Who helped Mia when she fell into the water?

A: Leo **caught** her hand just in time.

Story 16

The Day We Made a Mini Water Cycle

Story

Last Monday, our science teacher, Ms. Lin, **brought** a metal pot, a cold glass lid, and a bag of ice to class. "Today," she **said**, "we are going to learn about the water cycle." She **set** the pot on a small electric heater and **put** some water in it. The whole class **sat** around the lab table and watched with curiosity. After a few minutes, we **saw** tiny bubbles forming at the bottom of the pot. The water **began** to boil, and white steam **rose** into the air. "What you see rising from the pot is called water vapor," Ms. Lin **said**, "and when water heats up and changes into a gas, we call that evaporation." She **took** the cold glass lid and **held** it just above the rising steam. Almost at once, we **saw** something exciting—tiny water drops **began** to appear on the inside of the lid. "Did you see that?" Ms. Lin **said**, pointing at the lid. "The water vapor **rose** from the hot water and **hit** the cold surface of the lid." "The cold lid **made** the vapor cool down and become liquid water drops again." "This process is called condensation," she **told** us. We watched as more and more drops formed on the lid. The drops **grew** bigger and heavier over time. Then some of them **fell** back into the pot, just like raindrops falling from the sky. "What you just **saw** is called precipitation," Ms. Lin **said** with a smile. Next, she **took** a bowl filled with ice and **held** it above the steam instead. The cold bottom of the bowl **became** covered with tiny drops, and they **fell** back down just the same. "Now let me show you the big picture," Ms. Lin **said**. She **drew** a diagram on the board showing the sun, the ocean, clouds, and rain. "In nature," she explained, "the sun gives heat energy to oceans and lakes." "That heat makes the water evaporate and rise as water vapor into the sky." "High up in the sky, the water vapor meets cold air and condenses into tiny water droplets." "Billions of those tiny droplets come together and form clouds." "When the droplets grow heavy enough, they fall as rain or snow—and that is precipitation." "The water then flows back into rivers and oceans, and the whole

process begins again." "This endless loop is what we call the water cycle," she **said**. Suddenly, everything **made** sense to us. One student, Kevin, raised his hand and **said**, "So the water in our pot **went** through a mini water cycle!" Ms. Lin smiled and **said**, "Exactly right, Kevin." That day, we all **left** class with a brand-new understanding of how water keeps moving around our planet.

Verbs in this story

Base	Past	Past Participle	Meaning
bring	brought	brought	to carry something to a place
say	said	said	to speak words out loud
set	set	set	to put something in a certain place or position
put	put	put	to move something to a place or position
sit	sat	sat	to rest with your body on a seat
see	saw	seen	to notice something with your eyes
begin	began	begun	to start doing or happening
rise	rose	risen	to move up to a higher level
take	took	taken	to pick up and carry something away
hold	held	held	to keep something firmly in your hands
hit	hit	hit	to touch something quickly and with force
make	made	made	to create or produce something new
tell	told	told	to give someone information using words
grow	grew	grown	to get bigger over time
fall	fell	fallen	to drop down to a lower place
become	became	become	to start to be something different
draw	drew	drawn	to make a picture using a pen or pencil
go	went	gone	to move from one place to another
leave	left	left	to go away from a place

Think about it

Q: Why did tiny water drops form on the cold glass lid?

A: The water vapor **rose** from the hot water and **hit** the cold surface of the lid. The cold surface **made** the vapor cool down and become liquid water drops again. This process is called condensation.

Q: What two cold objects did Ms. Lin use during the experiment, and what did she do with them?

A: She **took** a cold glass lid and **held** it above the steam, and she also **took** a bowl filled with ice and **held** it above the steam.

Q: How does the water cycle work in nature? Explain the three key steps.

A: The sun gives heat energy to oceans and lakes, making the water evaporate and rise as water vapor (evaporation). High in the sky, the vapor condenses into tiny droplets that form clouds (condensation). When the droplets grow heavy enough, they fall as rain or snow (precipitation), and the water flows back into rivers and oceans to begin the cycle again.

The New Kid

Story

Last autumn, I **came** to a new junior high school in Taipei as a transfer student. I **wore** my new uniform for the first time and **felt** nervous as I walked through the gate. My homeroom teacher **took** me to the classroom and **told** everyone my name. I **stood** at the front of the room and **said** a short greeting. Thirty pairs of eyes **were** on me, and I **felt** like a fish in a glass tank. I **sat** at a desk near the window and tried to stay calm. The morning **went** by slowly, and I barely **spoke** to anyone. At lunch, I **went** to the cafeteria alone and **found** a small table in the corner. I **ate** my lunch quietly and **thought** that this school would never feel like home. Just then, a girl **came** over with a warm smile and **said**, "Can I sit here?" Her name **was** Mei, and she **told** me all about the school in just a few minutes. She **had** just joined the basketball team and **was** excited about Sports Day. After lunch, Mei **led** me back to class and introduced me to her group of friends. In the afternoon, we **had** PE class, and the teacher **gave** each team a basketball. I **had** never played on a team before, so I **felt** unsure of myself. Mei **held** out her hand and **said**, "You're on my team — don't worry!" I **took** a deep breath and **ran** onto the court with her. At first, I **stood** far from the action and **felt** lost on the big court. Then, near the end of the game, Mei **threw** the ball to me from across the court. I **caught** it in surprise, turned around, and **shot** toward the basket. The ball **went** in, and everyone on our team **ran** toward me and cheered. Mei **gave** me a high five and **said**, "I **knew** you could do it!" I **felt** warm inside for the first time that whole day. After school, Mei **showed** me around the building and **told** me the best spots on campus. At the school gate, I **met** Da-Wei, a friend of Mei's, who **had** the same comic book I **brought** from my old school. Da-Wei and I talked about the story for so long that we **forgot** to go home on time. When I finally **heard** my phone ring, I **told** my mom I **had** already **made** new friends. On the bus ride home, I **wrote** in my journal about the whole day. I **thought**

about how scared I **felt** in the morning, and how lucky I **was** now. The next morning, I **woke** up early, **put** on my uniform, and **felt** excited to see my new friends again.

Verbs in this story

Base	Past	Past Participle	Meaning
come	came	come	to move toward a place or person
wear	wore	worn	to have clothes on your body
feel	felt	felt	to notice something happening in your body or mind
take	took	taken	to pick up and carry something away
tell	told	told	to give someone information using words
stand	stood	stood	to be on your feet, not sitting
say	said	said	to speak words out loud
be	was / were	been	to exist, or to happen
sit	sat	sat	to rest with your body on a seat
go	went	gone	to move from one place to another
speak	spoke	spoken	to use your voice to say words
find	found	found	to see or get something after looking for it
eat	ate	eaten	to put food in your mouth and swallow it
think	thought	thought	to use your mind to form ideas or opinions
have	had	had	to own something or hold it as yours
lead	led	led	to go first and show others the way
give	gave	given	to hand something to someone
hold	held	held	to keep something firmly in your hands
run	ran	run	to move very fast using your legs
throw	threw	thrown	to send something through the air with your hand
catch	caught	caught	to take hold of something that is moving
shoot	shot	shot	to fire a gun or weapon at something
know	knew	known	to have information in your mind
show	showed	shown	to let someone see something
meet	met	met	to come together with someone in the same place
bring	brought	brought	to carry something to a place

forget	forgot	forgotten	to not be able to remember something
hear	heard	heard	to notice sounds with your ears
make	made	made	to create or produce something new
write	wrote	written	to make letters or words on paper
wake	woke	woken	to stop sleeping and open your eyes
put	put	put	to move something to a place or position

Think about it

Q: How did the narrator feel when the teacher took them to the front of the class, and what did the narrator say?

A: The narrator felt nervous. The narrator stood at the front of the room and said a short greeting.

Q: What happened when Mei threw the ball to the narrator during PE class?

A: The narrator caught it in surprise, shot toward the basket, and the ball went in.

Q: How did the narrator's feelings change from the morning to the end of the day?

A: The narrator felt warm inside after making new friends. The narrator thought about how scared they felt in the morning and how lucky they were now.